

100 Days of Linux - Day 016

Title: Viewing Files with more

Today's Goal

Learn how to read text files page by page using the **more** command and understand how it differs from **less**.

Why This Matters

Although **less** is more powerful, you'll still encounter **more** on many Linux systems. Knowing both commands makes you more comfortable working in different environments.

Command of the Day: more

Syntax: more filename

Explanation: Displays a file one screen at a time.

Keyboard Shortcuts:

Space = Next page

Enter = Next line

q = Quit

Example: more employees.txt

Beginner Lesson

The **more** command is similar to **less**, but it has fewer features. It is useful for reading long text files one page at a time. In modern Linux systems, **less** is generally preferred because it supports backward navigation and better searching.

Practice Questions

1. Create a file named manual.txt with at least 25 lines and open it using more.
2. Scroll to the next page using the correct keyboard shortcut.
3. Advance one line at a time using the correct key.
4. Exit the more viewer correctly.
5. Display your current working directory after finishing the exercise.

Hints

Create a text file with many lines so that more displays multiple pages.

Mini Challenge

Create a file named project_notes.txt with 40 lines. Open it using more, move through several pages, then quit and display the file using less. Observe the differences.

Common Mistakes

Expecting more to have all the navigation features of less. It is a

simpler viewer.

Did You Know?

The less command was created as an improved replacement for more—hence the joke: 'less is more.'

Pro Tip

When reading very large log files, most professionals choose less, but it's still useful to recognize more on older systems.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: more manual.txt

Q2: Press Space

Q3: Press Enter

Q4: Press q

Q5: pwd

Homework

Practice opening two large text files with both more and less. Compare how they behave.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn the nano text editor and start creating and editing files directly from the terminal.